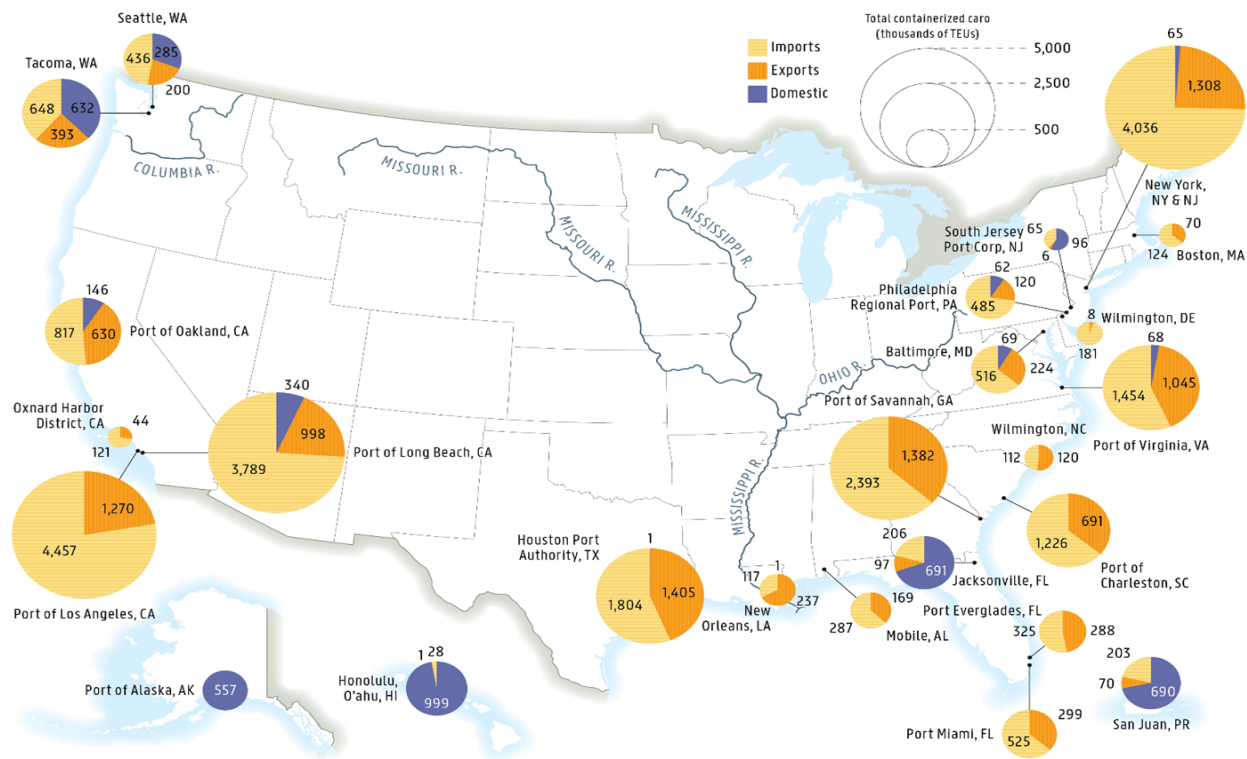




1. Background

This figure is a U.S. map displaying containerized cargo activity at major ports. Each port is represented by a proportional pie chart showing import (yellow), export (orange), and domestic (blue) container volumes in thousands of TEUs. Circle size denotes total containerized cargo handled by each port. High-volume ports such as Los Angeles, Long Beach, New York/New Jersey, and Savannah feature prominently with large circles.

2. Text Contrast

Most labels—including port names and TEU values—are in black text on a light background, providing adequate contrast. Numeric values placed directly on colored slices maintain good readability, although text placed over lighter yellow import slices has marginal contrast. The visibility of text remains generally acceptable but could be improved with darker or outlined text on light fills.

3. Graphic (Slice) Contrast

Color contrast across the three variables—yellow (imports), orange (exports), and dark blue (domestic)—is strong. The dark blue domestic slices are especially easy to distinguish. However, the yellow and orange slices are adjacent hues and may be difficult for some users to differentiate. The size scaling of circles is clear and proportional, though smaller ports produce very small slices that may be harder to interpret visually.

4. Color-Blind Safety

The yellow–orange color pairing may present limitations for users with red–green or blue–yellow deficiencies. These slices may appear too similar to reliably differentiate. Domestic cargo (dark blue) remains accessible across most color-blind conditions. Because the map relies entirely on color to encode imports vs. exports, the chart lacks redundant encoding (patterns, outlines) that would strengthen accessibility.

5. OCR / Text Size

Most numeric labels and port names are legible and reasonably sized. However, dense coastal areas—particularly the Southeast, Mid-Atlantic, and California—contain overlapping or tightly clustered labels that may reduce OCR accuracy. Very small ports or small domestic/export values may be difficult for OCR systems to read with precision.

6. Blur & DPI

The overall image is clear with sufficient resolution for digital use. Finer geographic details, such as state boundaries and river outlines, remain crisp. Small pie slices, especially those from ports with minimal exports or domestic cargo, may lose clarity if printed at low resolution or subjected to compression. Exporting the final version at ≥ 300 DPI is recommended.

7. Alt Text Recommendation

A recommended 508-compliant alt text description: “ Map of the United States showing containerized cargo activity at major ports. Each port is represented by a proportional pie chart with yellow for imports, orange for exports, and dark blue for domestic shipments. The largest volumes are shown at Los Angeles, Long Beach, New York/New Jersey, Savannah, and Virginia. Smaller ports across the West Coast, Gulf Coast, East Coast, and Caribbean are also displayed with appropriately scaled charts. Total cargo is expressed in thousands of TEUs. ”